

AI- RUBIN'S NEXT PLAYGROUND



We know how Andy Rubin's Android has created an impact in the world of technology and how the father of Android is developing the next platform, Artificial Intelligence. Here is what Playground Global, Rubin's foundation to develop AI, is going about developing the AI of tomorrow. <http://dgit.in/PlygrndGbl>

BEST MECHANICAL KEYBOARDS YOU CAN BUY RIGHT NOW



After the science behind making the perfect keyboard, we bring you a list of 15 best mechanical keyboards that you can buy right now with detailed reviews and all the information you'd need to make an informed decision. <http://dgit.in/BstMKybd>

DATING APPS WINNING THE HEARTS



Celebrated valentine's day with yet another gadget? Maybe it's high time you start finding the "one" using apps like Tinder, Badoo, etc. You'll be surprised how the market for these dating apps is growing and their success rates have been skyrocketing. <http://dgit.in/DtngAppsRS>

LET'S FACE THE REALITY



VR and AR are already huge and they're just getting bigger but there are so many unreal expectations which threaten and question their long term potential. Are we expecting a bit too much from these technologies? Know where we stand and what is safe to expect from the future when it comes to AR and VR. <http://dgit.in/ARVRRLty>

Why are we so interested in Apple's Virtual Reality deeds?

Patent approvals, employee recruitments, analyst reports and a circulating whisper of the "next big thing" adds up to only one thing – Apple's foray into VR is not too far away. Will this have the same impact that the iPhone had on the smartphone industry?

– By Souvik Das

With Virtual Reality becoming a widely appreciated field, numerous stalwarts of technology are taking their nascent steps into Virtual Reality, Augmented Reality, and the seemingly endless possibilities that these fields represent. Swiping the thin air with your hand to switch to the next music track is almost a reality, and live virtual music concerts will soon see bands playing to a virtually packed Slane Castle meadow, with virtual audiences. In such times, with Sony's Morpheus, Microsoft's HoloLens, Facebook's Oculus, Google's (very basic) Cardboard, HTC's Vive and Samsung's Gear VR virtual reality headsets, there's only one name that is missing — Apple.

While the Cupertino-based behemoth has remained tight-lipped about its involvement with virtual reality, there have been signs and traces, and some of them have been very prominent. Apple had filed for a patent for its virtual reality headset design back in 2008, which was finally approved in February 2015. In reply to Piper Jaffray analyst Gene Munster's question on Apple's involvement with Virtual Reality, CEO Tim Cook stated that he did not think virtual reality is a "niche". He said, "It's really cool and has some interesting applications."

This line itself brings us to the point, why are we talking exclusively about Apple entering the field of Virtual Reality?

Why are we talking about Apple entering VR?

This falls in line with what Apple did to the smartphone industry with the iPhone — make it really cool with a number of interesting applications. Apple has recently been acquiring a number of startups in the space of VR and AR, some of the notable ones



being Flyby Media, Metaio, Emotient Inc. and PrimeSense. Each of these companies specialise in certain aspects of VR and AR, and have previously worked with major companies. Flyby Media has expertise in computer vision, a brand of technology that facilitates 3D mapping and placement of real objects in virtual landscapes.

Metaio simulates real furniture in 3D space, PrimeSense makes camera hardware to enable computer vision and Emotient Inc. uses artificial intelligence and advanced sensors to gauge facial expressions.

Adding to this, The Financial Times had reported that Apple has an underground team of researchers working on a Virtual Reality project. Recent designations and job listings across the Internet happen to suggest the same. Nick Thompson, part of Microsoft's HoloLens project, has been roped in by Apple, and so has Doug Bowman, a human-computer interaction researcher at Virginia Tech. Incidentally, Bowman was also a lead author of the book, *3D User Interfaces: Theory and Practice*, and was one of the first to receive Microsoft's \$100,000 grants to work on the HoloLens. With a number of large-name acquisitions taking up desks at Apple, we are somewhat certain (hopeful, rather) that they are working on something that will define what Apple does the best — bring in the best of an industry together.

Apple has also recently added a \$30 Virtual Reality Starter Pack by View-Master, that uses an iPhone to push for smartphone-based augmented reality content, similar to Google Cardboard.

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